

ADENTAN MUNICIPAL EDUCATION OFFICE

GovPay Desk

How to prepare, approve and record payments

CSIT622 Capstone Project

University of Ghana · Department of Computer Science

Group 7

Adentan Municipal Education Office

This guide explains how to use GovPay Desk to prepare, approve and record payments. It assumes no technical knowledge. Each section covers one task.

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1. What this system is for

The office pays suppliers, contractors and staff. Before money leaves the office, someone prepares a **payment voucher** describing who is being paid, how much, and why. Someone else checks and approves it. Only then is the payment made.

On paper, this is slow and hard to check afterwards. Vouchers go missing. Nobody can say for certain who approved what, or when.

GovPay Desk does the same job on screen. It keeps the record of every step automatically, so at the end of the year the office can show exactly what was paid, who approved it, and what evidence supports it.

Three rules the system will not let you break:

- The person who prepares a voucher cannot approve their own voucher.
- A voucher that has been approved or paid cannot be edited.
- Nobody can approve a payment larger than the limit set for them.

These are not suggestions. The system refuses.

2. Signing in

1. Open the web address your administrator gave you.
2. Type your email address and password.
3. Select **Log in**.

If you get the password wrong five times, the system stops accepting attempts for a minute. This protects the office against someone guessing passwords.

Forgotten your password? Select **Forgot password** on the sign-in page and follow the emailed link.

Two-step sign-in. You can add a second step using an app on your phone. Go to **Settings** → **Two-Factor Auth**. Once switched on, you enter a six-digit code from your phone each time you sign in. This is recommended for anyone who approves payments.

3. Finding your way around

The menu on the left is grouped by what you are doing:

Group	What is in it
Payments	The dashboard, payment vouchers, the approval queue, memos
Records	Supporting documents, ledger transactions, chart of accounts, reports
Administration	Departments, staff, roles, audit log — administrators only

If you do not see the Administration group, you are not an administrator. That is normal.

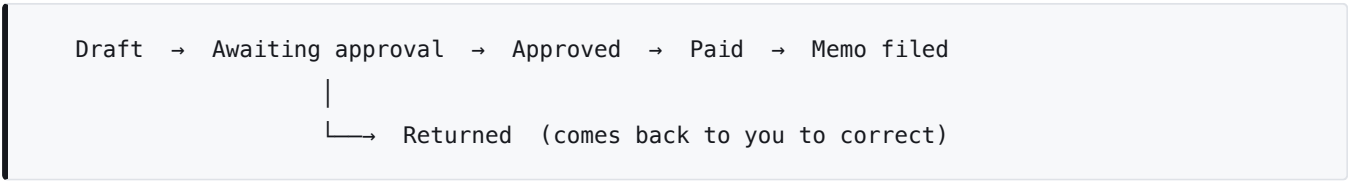
The bar at the top has:

- the **bell**, showing anything waiting for you — a red number means unread
- **Quick Actions**, to start a new voucher or memo from anywhere
- a **light and dark** switch

On a phone, the menu is behind the button at the top left.

4. The life of a payment

Every payment moves through the same stages, in order:



Stage	What it means	Who acts next
Draft	Being prepared. Nobody else has seen it.	You — finish and submit it
Awaiting approval	Submitted. Waiting for a decision.	An approver
Returned	Sent back with a reason. Can be edited.	You — correct and resubmit
Approved	Cleared for payment.	The accountant
Paid	Money released. Recorded in the ledger.	Optionally raise a memo

The dashboard shows how many vouchers sit at each stage.

5. Preparing a payment voucher

Who can do this: Finance Officers and Administrators.

1. Select **Quick Actions** → **Create voucher**, or go to **Payment vouchers** and select **New payment voucher**.
2. Fill in the form. Fields marked with a red asterisk are required.

What each field means:

Field	What to put
Voucher date	The date of the payment request
Department	Which department the money comes from
Payee name	Exactly who is being paid, as on the invoice
Payee bank and account	Where the money is going, for a transfer
Amount	In Ghana cedis
Payment method	Cheque, bank transfer, or cash
Cheque number	Required if you chose cheque
Description	What the money is for, in plain words
Budget line	Which budget the spending comes out of

3. Select **Create Payment Voucher**.

The voucher is saved as a **draft**. It has a number like **PV-2026-014**. Nobody else sees it until you submit it.

Checks while you type

As you fill in the form, the system quietly compares what you have entered against past payments. If something looks unusual, a yellow box appears:

- **Possible duplicate** — the same payee was paid the same amount recently. Check you are not paying an invoice twice.

- **Unusually large** — the amount is far above what this department normally pays. Check the figure.
- **Budget line may be wrong** — your description mentions fuel but the budget line says office supplies, for example.

These are warnings, not errors. Every one of them can be perfectly correct. You can still save the voucher. The system is pointing something out, not refusing.

The system may also suggest a budget line based on your description. Select the suggestion to use it, or ignore it.

6. Attaching invoices and receipts

Open a draft or returned voucher and select **Attach a file** under *Supporting documents*.

- Accepted: PDF, JPG, PNG, Word, Excel
- Largest size: 10MB

Attach the supplier's invoice before submitting. Approvers frequently return vouchers for missing invoices, and this is the most common reason for delay.

Once a voucher is approved or paid, its documents can no longer be removed. They are part of the financial record.

7. Sending a voucher for approval

From the **Payment vouchers** list, select **Submit** on a draft.

The system works out who should approve it, based on the amount:

Amount	Approval level
Up to GHS 5,000	Level 1 — Routine
Up to GHS 50,000	Level 2 — Standard
Up to GHS 250,000	Level 3 — Senior
Above GHS 250,000	Level 4 — Executive

Only approvers whose limit covers the amount are notified. A GHS 300,000 payment does not appear in a junior officer's queue.

Once submitted, you cannot edit the voucher. If you need to change something, ask an approver to return it.

8. Approving or returning a voucher

Who can do this: Approvers and Administrators.

Go to **Awaiting approval**. Each voucher shows the payee, the amount, the department, who prepared it, and how long it has been waiting. Anything waiting three days or more is marked in red.

Before deciding, look at:

- **Yellow warning boxes** — automatic checks that flagged something
- **The approval band** — which level this amount falls into
- **Supporting documents** — is the invoice attached?

Asking the AI for a second opinion

Select **AI review**. The system sends the voucher and the department's recent payment history to Claude, an AI service, and shows back:

- a risk level — low, medium or high
- one sentence summarising the position
- specific things to check

This is advice, not a decision. The AI cannot approve or reject anything. It has no authority over the payment. You decide, and the record shows that you decided. If the AI is unavailable, the button says so and you carry on as normal.

Approving

Select **Approve** and confirm. The voucher moves to *Approved* and the preparer is notified.

If **Approve** is greyed out, either you prepared this voucher yourself, or the amount is above your limit. The reason is shown on screen.

Returning a voucher

Select **Return**, then write what needs correcting. Be specific — the preparer sees exactly what you write, and a vague reason means another round trip.

Good: *"The supplier invoice is not attached and the quantities do not match the requisition."*

Not useful: *"Incorrect."*

9. Recording a payment

Who can do this: Finance Officers and Administrators.

Once the money has actually left the office, find the approved voucher and select **Mark as paid**.

The system then records the payment in the ledger automatically, as a pair of matching entries:

- the expense is charged to the right budget account
- cash or bank is reduced by the same amount

You do not do anything for this to happen. You can see the result under **Records** → **Transactions**. Total debits and total credits always match; if they ever did not, the page would say so in red.

10. Writing a memo

A memo is a short internal note recording that a payment was made, for the file.

1. Go to **Memos** → **New memo**.
2. Choose the paid voucher the memo is about.
3. Fill in the subject, who it is to, who it is from, and the body.
4. Select **Create memo**.

Letting the AI write the first draft

Select **Draft with AI**. The system writes a subject and body from the voucher's details and puts them in the form.

Read it before saving. It is a starting point that saves typing, not a finished document. You can change every word, and nothing is saved until you select **Create memo**.

Finishing a memo

- **Finalize** — the memo is complete. It can no longer be edited.
- **Mark printed** — a paper copy has been printed and filed.

11. Reports

Under **Records** → **Reports**:

- **By month** — what was paid each month, with a total for the year
- **By department** — what each department spent, largest first

Both cover **paid** vouchers only. Money that has been approved but not yet released is not spending yet.

Use the year selector at the top right to look at a different year.

Print report opens a clean version and your printer dialogue. To save a PDF instead of printing, choose "Save as PDF" as the destination.

Every time a report is printed, the system records who did it and when. This is deliberate — reports leave the office as evidence.

The dashboard also shows two charts: spending per month over the last year, and spending per department this year.

12. The audit log

Who can see it: Administrators only.

Administration → **Audit log** lists every action taken in the system: who did it, what they did, when, and from which computer.

Nothing in the system can change or delete an entry. This is the record an auditor relies on, so it only ever grows.

You can filter by action type or search the descriptions.

13. Managing staff

Who can do this: Administrators only.

Administration → **Staff** lists everyone with access.

The four roles

Role	What they can do
Administrator	Everything, including managing staff and reading the audit log
Approver	Approve or return vouchers, up to their limit
Finance Officer	Prepare vouchers, attach documents, record payments
Viewer	Read only. Cannot create or change anything.

Adding someone

Select **Add user**, fill in their details, and choose a role. If you choose Approver, set their **approval limit** — the largest payment they may release. Leave it blank for no limit.

New accounts start with the password `password`. Tell the person to change it immediately under **Settings** → **Password**.

When someone leaves

Edit their account and switch **Active** off. They are signed out straight away and cannot sign back in. Their past vouchers and audit entries stay intact — the record of what they did must not disappear.

You cannot remove your own administrator role. This stops the office accidentally locking itself out.

14. Your account

Under **Settings**:

- **Profile** — your name, email and phone
 - **Password** — change your password
 - **Two-Factor Auth** — add the second sign-in step
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15. Common questions

I cannot edit my voucher. It has been submitted. Only drafts and returned vouchers can be edited. Ask an approver to return it.

The Approve button is greyed out. Either you prepared it — the same person cannot prepare and approve — or the amount is above your limit. The reason is on screen.

I got a warning but the payment is correct. Save it anyway. The warnings point things out; they do not block you. The approver sees the same warning and can judge for themselves.

The AI review is not working. The office may not have it switched on, or the service may be briefly unavailable. Approve or return using your own judgement — nothing else changes.

I paid the wrong voucher. Payments cannot be reversed in the system. Speak to your administrator; the correction is an accounting matter, and the audit log preserves what happened.

Someone has left. Should I delete their account? No. Switch **Active** off instead. Deleting would break the record of what they approved.

I cannot see the Administration menu. You are not an administrator. Ask one if you need something from it.
